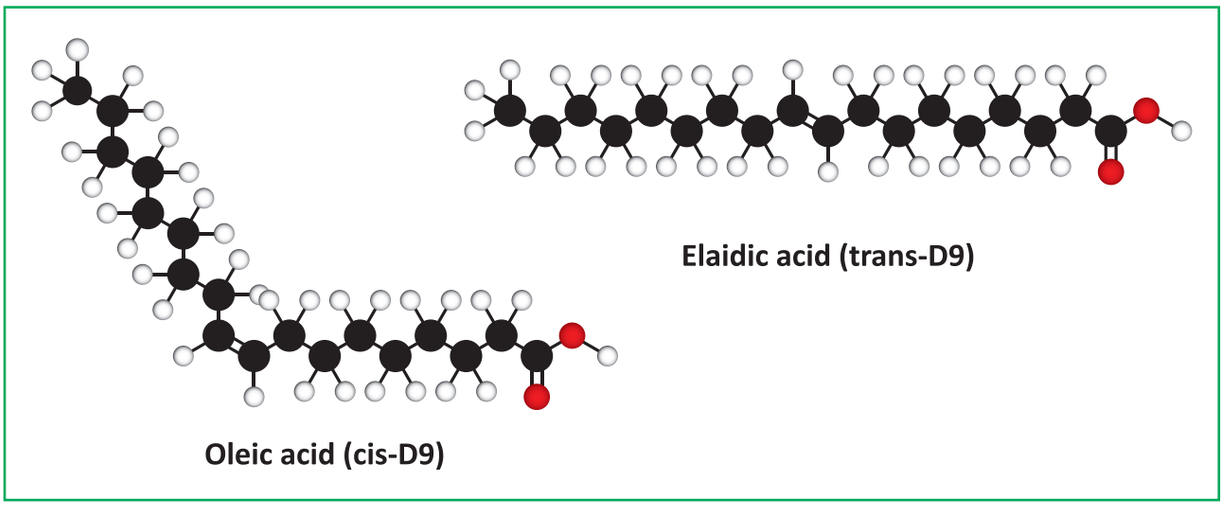
fattyacid is said to be a saturated fatty acid.



Unsaturated Fatty Acid

Figure 6.4: Stereo-chemical representation of unsaturated fatty acid

Unsaturated Fatty Acid

When one or more carbon-carbon double bonds are present, the fatty acid is called unsaturated. Depending on the number of double bonds present in the hydrocarbon chain, the fatty acid can be classified as:

- Monounsaturated fatty acid (MUFA) and
- Polyunsaturated fatty acid (PUFA)

Monounsaturated Fatty Acid:

A monounsaturated fatty acid contains one carbon-carbon double bond. Higher quantity monounsaturated fatty acids are present in olive oil, canola oil (mustard oil), peanut oil and sesame oil. The general formula is $C_nH_{2n-1}COOH$.

Polyunsaturated Fatty Acid:

Fatty acids with more than one double bond are polyunsaturated fatty acids. Foods with high amounts of polyunsaturated fats include: Walnuts, Sunflower seeds, Flax seeds or flax oil, Fish (such as salmon, mackerel, herring, albacore tuna, and trout), Corn oil and Soybean oil.

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